

047 Keep a nature journal

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Good naturalists keep a journal. Making notes on what you see, hear, and smell when nature-watching helps you remember observations. Include sketches, photos—even leaves, feathers, and flowers.

What you need
• Blank notebook or notepad • Pencil, pen, watercolors, or paints of your choice
• Tape • Binoculars

1 Go out and watch a plant, bird, or animal. Note down its appearance, behavior, and surroundings. Use all your senses. What can you hear? See? Smell?

2 Sketch your subject—note colors and distinctive marks. Tape any finds, such as leaves, to your journal pages.

Don't forget your hat!



3 Come back at other times of the year and record any changes.

Leaf specimen



048 Start a leaf collection

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Keep a record of trees and bushes by collecting their leaves. Find as many types as you can, tape or glue them onto paper, then identify them.

Fall leaves add color

